

NEW FACES OF T

Apart from Mumbai, the North American duo of Pakistani origin sought other targets in India. The

|By Mayank Chhaya in Chicago and Sandeep Unnithan|

It has been one of the biggest unsolved mysteries of the 26/11 Mumbai attacks. How did the 10-member Lashkar suicide commando team so effortlessly navigate around landmarks in a city which they hadn't visited? Now with the arrest of two persons by the FBI, David Coleman Headley, a white American of mixed Pakistani descent, and Tahawwur Hussain Rana, a Canadian national residing in Chicago, Indian investigators believe the smoke may finally be clearing.

The suspected Lashkar-e-Toiba (LeT) activists Headley and his accomplice Rana may have conducted a detailed hostile reconnaissance of the three targets—the Taj and Oberoi hotels and the Jewish centre at Nariman House—and possibly even had a hand in planning the attack and several other strikes across the country. The National Investigation Agency (NIA) which has registered a case against the duo under the Unlawful Activities Prevention Act and for conspiring to wage war against the country is now building up the home ministry's case asking for the duo's extradition. Transcripts of e-mails and phone taps supplied by the FBI show Rana and Headley plotting fresh mass casualty attacks in India, including defence installations and elite boarding schools in north India.

When Headley applied for an Indian visa in July 2007, nothing seemed out of the ordinary and no red flags went up. He was granted a five-year multiple entry visa by the Indian consulate in Chicago. A little over two years later, Headley, also known as Daood Gilani, is in federal custody in the city facing charges of having links with the LeT and conspiring to commit "murder and maiming". Arrested by the FBI on October 3, his "multiple trips" to India, Pakistan and Denmark are subject of a detailed investigation by the FBI. Swept

up along with him is Rana, a "medically trained" owner of an immigration business at Chicago's Devon Avenue, in the midst of a small stretch called "Little India". Rana is a Canadian citizen of Pakistani origin, who also has a permanent US residency and lives primarily in Chicago.

It is not entirely clear how the two Chicagoans, a Pakistani and the other a white American convert to Islam, met and struck up what according to the FBI was a potentially murderous alliance. Details about their personal backgrounds are not available in the criminal complaints but reports suggest that Headley was born in the US and



Terror LINKS

Between 2006 and 2009, American terror suspect David Headley stayed for close to nine months in India but also took several trips around the sub-continent which are now being investigated

David Headley

Passport no.: Z3144473
Issued on: March 10, 2006
Valid until: July 17, 2012

Tahawwur Rana

Passport issued on: March 3, 2006
Valid until: July 17, 2012

